

KSOC releases the first-ever KBOM standard

Kubernetes Security Operations Center (KSOC) has released the first-ever Kubernetes Bill of Materials (KBOM) standard. This KBOM, which is available in an open source CLI tool, helps cloud security teams comprehend the extent of third-party tooling in their environment so they can react more quickly to newly discovered vulnerabilities. Despite the substantial third-party tool ecosystem for Kubernetes, compliance rules for the software supply chain have mostly been disregarded.

Numerous Kubernetes tools, including Crossplane, the Jenkins plugin, CubeFS, and Clusternet, now have new vulnerabilities. Although the Software Bill of Materials (SBOM) is now mandatory for federal purchases in the US, this requirement falls short of the deployment stage in the application development life cycle, where Kubernetes comes into play.

A standard for the overall scope and configuration of a cluster is becoming necessary as teams continue their widespread use of Kubernetes. This uniform standard can make understaffed companies more efficient, especially when Kubernetes expertise is already in short supply.

The new KBOM standard provides a quick view of the scope of your Kubernetes cluster, including workload count, cost and type of hosting service, vulnerabilities for both internal and hosted images, third-party customisation, and more.

“Kubernetes is orchestrating the applications of many of the biggest business brands we know and love. Adoption is no longer an excuse, and yet from a security perspective, we continually leave Kubernetes itself out of the conversation when it comes to standards and compliance guidelines, focusing only on activity before application deployment,” said KSOC CTO Jimmy Mesta.

CISA takes over the UK government's 'Logging Made Easy' tool

The United Kingdom's National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC-UK) has discontinued funding for an open source program called 'Logging Made Easy' it developed to make it simpler to record security incidents on Windows operating systems. The United States' Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA), however, stepped in with a promise to maintain and update the tool not long after the UK declared it would stop providing support for the software.

The open source LME tool was created by NCSC-UK in the UK and released on GitHub in 2018 as a free tool. In order to “focus on the most significant cyber security challenges” and “divert resources to new initiatives designed to help

protect the UK's cyber infrastructure,” the UK cyber agency announced in January that it would stop supporting the tool as of March 31, this year.

According to a statement by CISA: “Neither agency will maintain code between now and when CISA reconstitutes the tool on their GitHub page.



Current users who continue to use LME during this intersessional period must maintain and update the tool independently, and do so at their own risk.”

“Our Logging Made Easy project has undeniably delivered results and we are proud to have supported thousands of defenders to keep their networks safe,” said Lindy Cameron, CEO, NCSC-UK. “The project's transition to oversight from CISA will mean that existing and new users of the tool will continue to reap the significant benefits that it provides.”

Though a specific date has not been determined, the tool will most likely be republished on CISA's GitHub page by the end of the summer.

Cisco launches open source security tools at KubeCon EU

At KubeCon+CloudNativeCon in Amsterdam this April, Cisco Systems, a longtime leader in the open source software community with more than 200 projects to its name, unveiled a collection of fresh open source tools for programmers concerned with application modernisation.

According to the firm, the three new additions—VMClarity, Nasp, and Media Streaming Mesh—have been made to enhance security for Kubernetes and cloud native systems in general. At the conference, Cisco's Emerging Technologies and Incubation division showcased how these tools increase the capabilities of cloud native settings by enhancing security tools, risk inventory in the application stack, and application modernisation.

The purpose of VMClarity is to address any issues that could arise while using virtual machines (VMs) in cloud native environments. “VMs are the No. 1 most-used service on public clouds and the predominant method for hosting containers,” Vijoy Pandey, Cisco's senior vice-president of engineering, wrote in a blog post. “The resulting attack paths can be more elaborate than Amsterdam's canal system. We saw a need to provide protection for VMs against security threats such as leaked secrets, malware, and rootkit as well as system misconfigurations and vulnerability scanning, as they are still very much part of how businesses run in the cloud.”